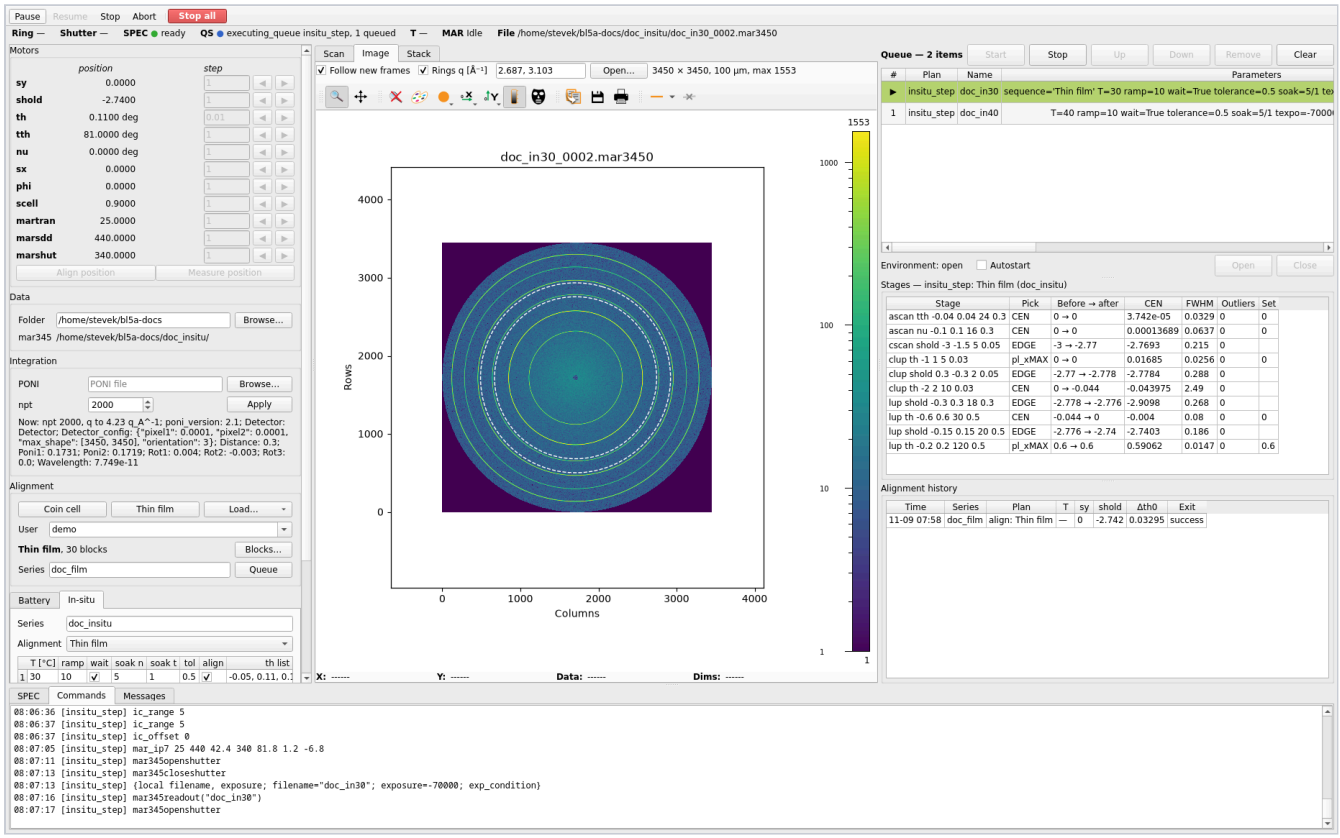
BL5A automation

One GUI that queues alignment and mar345 measurements at BL5A, integrates each frame with rsFAI, and stacks the profiles by time and temperature. It covers the two experiments in `5a.zip`:

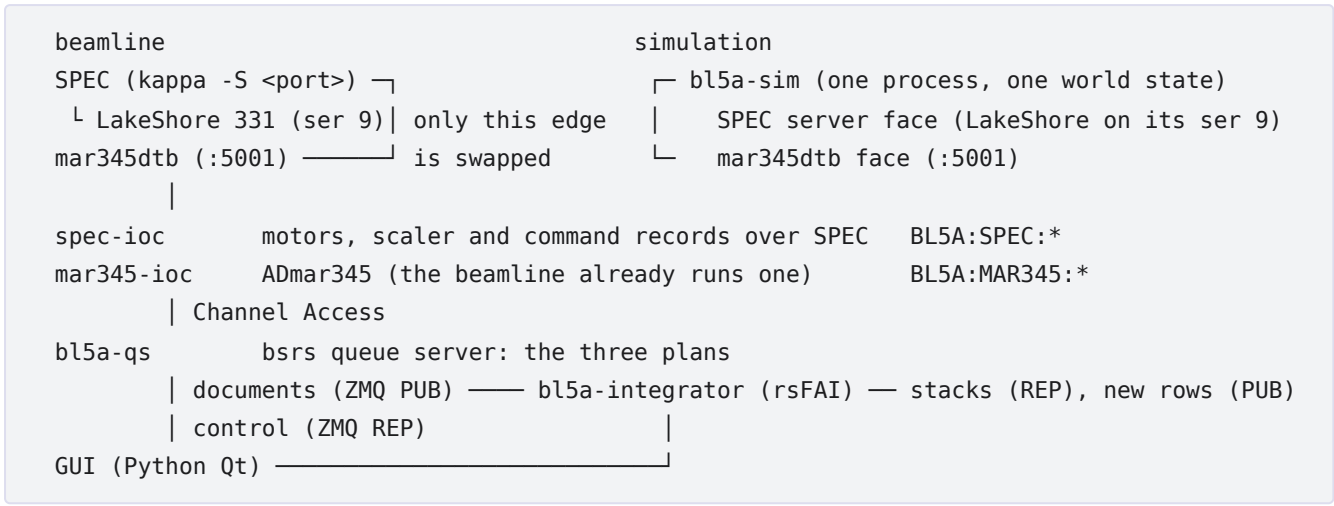
- **Battery (charge/discharge):** `coin_align`, then `mymar1` (one frame) or `mymar` (a frame every Ti minutes). The cycler is run from its own laptop.
- **Thin film vs temperature:** `myinsitu`: for each temperature `settemp`, then `align_in.mac`, then `mymar_in`.

Only what these two flows use is built: no general scan screen, no re-integration, no macros outside the two flows.



The GUI during an in-situ run

How it fits together



The queue and the integrator keep running when the GUI is closed. A temperature step, its alignment and its frames run inside one plan, not in the GUI.

What is in this directory

Path	What it is
`sim/`	`bl5a-sim`: a SPEC server and a mar345dtb over one simulated beamline
`qs/`	`bl5a-qs`: the bsrs queue server with the plans `align` (a block sequence), `mar_series`, `insitu_step`
`integrator/`	`bl5a-integrator`: integrates each frame, keeps one HDF5 stack per series and q axis in the series' data folder
`drivers/spec/`	the SPEC server protocol (`protocol/`, shared with bl5a-sim) and the SPEC client asyn driver (`driver/`)
`iocs/spec-ioc/`	`spec-ioc`: SPEC's motors, counters and command line as EPICS records
`ioc/spec/`	`st.cmd` and substitutions for spec-ioc (prefix `BL5A:SPEC:`)
`ioc/mar345/`	`st.cmd` for mar345-ioc (prefix `BL5A:MAR345:`), for the simulation
`deploy/`	`install.sh`, the user systemd services, the settings templates, the GUI's desktop shortcut and the GUI's and MCP server's launchers
`gui/`	the Python Qt GUI (`gui/run_gui.py`), its MCP server for Claude Code or Codex (`gui/run_mcp.py`), their tests and the vendored bl7c widgets
`.mcp.json`	Claude Code's entry for the MCP server (`deploy/bl5a-mcp`), with this machine's paths
`ref/spec/`	the beamline's SPEC config `kappa.config` (bl5a-sim reads it), the macro extractor for the SPEC state files in `261104_spec_d.tar.gz`, and splot's peak code
`doc/usage.md`	how to use the GUI, with screenshots
`doc/install.md`	how to build it and install it at the beamline
`doc/design.md`	the design notes (Korean)

`deploy/install.sh` builds mar345-ioc from https://github.com/epics-rs/epics-rs-iocs at the commit `Cargo.toml` pins. See doc/install.md.

Quick start with the simulation

It needs the Rust toolchain (rustup), a C/C++ compiler, network access to github.com and crates.io, and a Python 3 with the GUI's packages (versions in doc/install.md).

Install once, then start the services:

```
deploy/install.sh --sim --python /path/to/python
systemctl --user enable --now bl5a.target
```

`install.sh` builds everything in release mode, writes the settings to `~/.config/bl5a/`, installs five user services and puts a **BL5A** shortcut on the desktop and in the applications menu. The `systemctl` line starts the services now and again at every login:

Service	What it runs
`bl5a-sim`	the simulated beamline: SPEC server on port 16510, mar345dtb on 5001
`bl5a-spec-ioc`	spec-ioc, `BL5A:SPEC:*`, Channel Access on port 25064
`bl5a-mar345-ioc`	mar345-ioc, `BL5A:MAR345:*`, Channel Access on port 25066
`bl5a-qs`	the queue server
`bl5a-integrator`	the integrator

Then open the GUI with the **BL5A** shortcut. Claude Code started in this directory finds the MCP server through `.mcp.json`.

The data goes to `~/bl5a-data`: each queue item gets a folder there, named after its series, holding its frames, its scans as a SPEC file and its integrated stacks. The Channel Access ports keep the simulation off the site network.

```
systemctl --user status 'bl5a*'             # what runs
journalctl --user -u bl5a-qs -f             # one service's log
systemctl --user restart bl5a.target        # after changing ~/.config/bl5a/*.env
systemctl --user disable --now bl5a.target  # stop them, and not at the next login
set -a; . ~/.config/bl5a/bl5a.env; set +a   # CA settings, for caget
```

The simulation's options go in `BL5A_SIM_ARGS` in `~/.config/bl5a/bl5a.env`: `--sample coin` simulates a coin cell instead of a film, `--seed N` fixes the simulated offsets, `--pos tth=81` sets a start position and `--config FILE` takes another SPEC config (for example with faster motors). `bl5a-sim --help` lists the rest.

Tests

```
cargo nextest run --workspace
QT_QPA_PLATFORM=offscreen PYTHONPATH=gui python -m pytest -q gui/tests
```

Limits

- The temperature IOC (`BL5A:TC:*`) is not built. `insitu_step` sets the temperature with the SPEC macros in `temperature.mac` on the LakeShore 331's serial line, and the GUI's temperature field reads "—".
- No suspenders: a beam dump does not pause a plan.
- **Align position** and **Measure position** are disabled until BL5A gives the positions.
- The simulation serves no ring current or shutter PV, so those fields read "—" there.